Marcelo Wilchinski Hirschfeld

PhD Candidate in Political Science, UC San Diego
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Research Interests

State Development, Historical Political Economy, Political Geography, Inter-State and Civil Conflict, Political Regimes, Labor Systems, Latin America

Education

UC San Diego
Ph.D. in Political Science with a Computational Social Science Specialization 2028 (expected)
- *Dissertation Committee*: Sebastian M. Saiegh (chair), Agustina Paglayan, David Lake, Samuel Bazzi and Francisco Garfias.

UC San Diego
M.A. in Political Science 2025
- *Subfields*: Comparative Politics and International Relations/Methods

Universidad de la Republica (UdelaR), Uruguay
Diploma in International Studies 2022
Diploma in Economics 2021
B.A. in Political Science 2020

Research

Working Papers

- The Resource Blessing. How Commodity Booms Ended Territorial Disputes in South America.
- Labor Supply and European Territorial Centralization: Evidence from the Black Death.

Works in Progress

- The Price of Sovereignty: Labor Control and the Size of Nations.
- State-Building during the Second Slavery: A Bargaining Framework.
- Phantom Variation: How Partially Time-Invariant Controls Tilt Two-Way Fixed Effects Estimates and How to Fix It (with Sebastian M. Saiegh)

Pre-Ph.D. Publications (in Spanish)

- 2023. Las donaciones de China hacia América Latina y sus determinantes: Enseñanzas del caso uruguayo. *Revista Uruguaya de Ciencia Política* (with Diego Telias).

- 2022. La batalla virtual por la memoria: un análisis de las memorias en disputa durante la Marcha del Silencio del 2020 en Twitter en Uruguay. *Teknokultura. Revista de Cultura Digital y Movimientos Sociales* (with Federico Acosta y Lara).
- 2021. "We are fantastic": Are We? in Moraes, J. y Pérez, V. (ed.) *De la estabilidad al equilibrio inestable: elecciones y comportamiento electoral en Uruguay, 2019.* Montevideo: UdelaR (with Juan Moraes and Federico Acosta y Lara).

Awards and Grants

2026 Travel Grant, Empirical Studies of Conflict - ReCIPE Annual Meeting
2026 Travel Grant, International Conflict Lab - University of Alabama
2025 Marsha Chandler Fellowship, UC San Diego
- For academic excellence in PhD coursework

Conference Participations

2026 Empirical Studies of Conflict - ReCIPE Annual Meeting (Forthcoming)
2026 Comparative Politics UCSD Retreat (Presenter)
2026 International Relations UCSD Retreat (Presenter)
2026 Workshop on International Conflict - International Conflict Lab at the University of Alabama (Presenter)
2022 Latin American Political Methodology (LAPolMeth) Meeting
2022 VIII -Annual Conference of the Red para el Estudio de la Economía Política de América Latina (REPAL)
2021 VII - Congreso Uruguayo de Ciencia Política (AUCIP -UdelaR) (Presenter)
2019 VI - Congreso Uruguayo de Ciencia Política (AUCIP -UdelaR)

Teaching and Research Assistantships

Teaching Assistant

- POLI 104J: Introduction to Legal Reasoning (Nichter)
  Winter 2024, Winter 2025, Summer 2025, Fall 2026
- POLI 140A: International Law (Benliogullari)
  Summer 2026
- POLI 30D: Political Inquiry (Anderson)
  Spring 2026
- POLI 104U: Introduction to Business Law (Nichter)
  Spring 2025, Summer 2025, Winter 2026
- POLI 134D: Politics, Policies, and Economic Prosperity in Latin America (Saiegh)
  Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Fall 2025
- POLI 163: Analyzing Politics (Saiegh)
  Fall 2024, Fall 2025

- POLI 140: International Human Rights Law — Rights of Migrants (Wong)
  Spring 2024

Research Assistant

- Collected and analyzed data for research projects on the historical development of education systems (Paglayan)
  Summer 2026

Other Work Experience

2020 Regulatory and Control Unit of Personal Data - AGESIC, Uruguay - *Consultant*

- In charge of the evaluation of the personal data protection policy in the Uruguayan central administration.

Languages and Skills

Languages: Spanish (Native), English (fluent), Portuguese (intermediate)
Skills: R, LaTeX

References

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